

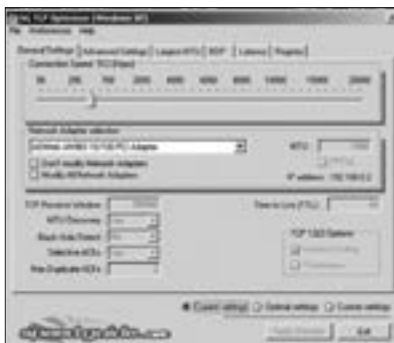
5.3.1 Connection Optimisers

These are utilities that alter Windows' default network settings to suit the kind of connection you have.

5.3.1.1 TCP Optimizer

(<http://www.speedguide.net/downloads.php>)

This is a utility that can change network settings based on the speed of connection you select. The speed settings start from 56 Kbps and go up to 20 Mbps. Depending on the speed of your connection, TCP Optimizer can set the optimal settings by itself, or you can manually enter values. Since Registry entries are modified, TCP Optimizer keeps a backup, and if the modifications prove counterproductive, the values can be restored. Additionally, the settings can also be reverted to the Windows default values.



The TCP Optimizer window

Easy MTU is another utility that accomplishes much the same.

5.3.2 Ad Blockers

Even if network connections are optimised, browsing can be bogged down by unwanted content—for example, ads. Ad blocking can also be seen as a part of optimising your connection, since the end result remains that your browsing speed is reduced to a crawl by all the pop-ups, pop-unders, banners, and Flash ads of all sizes. Ad blocking can take place in two ways—either preventing data from ad-serving URLs from loading, or by blocking images of a certain size (for example, banner ads usually stick to the same dimensions).

5.3.2.1 Proxomitron (www.spamblocked.com/proxomitron/)

Proxomitron offers the most comprehensive protection from